# Employee Handbook and HR Assist Request Guide

DEMO ONLY: sample company policy for testing HR Assist. Replace it with your company's approved handbook.

## 1. Using HR Assist

HR Assist is the employee self-service portal for HR and IT support.

- Log in with your company email ID and password. New employees receive their starting password from HR and can change it under My Profile.
- Chat: ask any question about HR policies, leave, public holidays, work from home, expenses, payroll or IT problems.
- Raise a Request: submit leave, work from home, IT support, holiday, payroll or other HR requests.
- Every request is emailed to HR automatically. You receive an email when HR approves or rejects it.
- My Requests: track the status (Pending, Approved or Rejected) and read the HR comment.
- If you forget your password, contact HR. HR can reset it from the admin panel.

## 2. Leave policy

Leave year is the calendar year (January to December). Leave is counted in working days; Saturdays, Sundays and public holidays inside the leave period are not counted.

- Annual Leave: 18 working days per year for full-time employees.
- Sick Leave: 12 working days per year. For sick leave longer than 2 consecutive days, a medical certificate may be requested.
- Casual Leave: 6 working days per year, for short personal needs; at most 3 consecutive days.
- Your current balance is shown on the Home page and in My Profile. You can also ask the chatbot: What is my leave balance?
- Leave taken without balance is treated as loss of pay (LOP).

## 3. How to apply for leave

- Open Raise a Request and choose the category Leave.
- Select the leave type (Annual, Sick or Casual) and the start and end dates. The app calculates the working days automatically.
- Add a short reason and submit. HR receives an email immediately.
- Apply for planned leave at least 3 working days in advance. Sick leave can be applied on the same day.
- When HR approves, the days are deducted from your balance and you get an email. If rejected, the HR comment explains why.

## 4. Public holidays

The company follows the Government of India list of gazetted public holidays (see the Holiday Calendar 2026-2027 document and the Holidays page). Each year has 17 gazetted holidays. In addition, employees may take up to 2 restricted (optional) holidays per year; request them with the category Holiday Query.

## 5. Work from home

- Employees may work from home up to 2 days per week with manager approval, subject to role requirements.

- Submit a Work From Home request at least 1 working day in advance with the dates and reason.
- Stay reachable during working hours (10:00 to 18:30) and attend required meetings.

## 6. IT support

Describe the problem in the chat or raise an IT Support request. The chatbot first gives self-help steps and then creates an IT ticket that is emailed to HR/IT.

- Response targets: Urgent - within 4 working hours; High - within 1 working day; Medium - within 2 working days; Low - within 5 working days.
- Include the device or application, when the problem started and any error message.
- Never share passwords, one-time codes or API keys in a request or in the chat.

## 7. Payroll and expenses

- Salary is credited on the last working day of each month. Payslips are shared by email in the first week of the next month.
- For salary, payslip, tax or bank-account questions, raise a request with the category Payroll / Salary.
- Approved expense claims are reimbursed with the next monthly salary.

## 8. Request categories and response time

HR responds to every request within 2 working days.

- Leave - annual, sick or casual leave.
- Work From Home - remote work days.
- IT Support - laptop, Wi-Fi, VPN, password, software or email problems.
- Holiday Query - public or restricted holiday questions.
- Payroll / Salary - salary, payslips, tax, reimbursement.
- HR Query - any other HR policy question.
- Other - anything else.

## 9. Contact

Use HR Assist for all HR and IT requests so they are tracked. For urgent matters, contact the HR team at hr.admin@company.com.